

Kazakhstan

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** June 4, 1992 **Usage:** National and Civil

The sky-blue field symbolizes the skies stretching over the many Kazakh people



A berkut, or steppe eagle, beneath a shining sun

The traditional “national ornamentation” is placed close to the hoist

Asia



Part of Central Asia conquered by Russia in the 18th century, **Kazakhstan** was the largest republic to secede from the USSR.

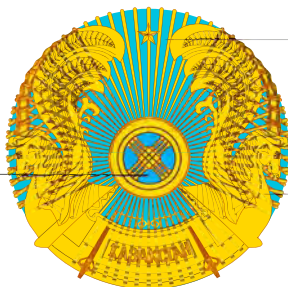
Kazakhstan's post-communist flag was adopted in 1992. Its sky-blue background recalls the endless skies over the Kazakh people. It also symbolizes well-being, tranquility, peace, and unity. In the center of the flag, below a golden sun with 32 rays, soars a bird of the species known locally as the *berkut*, or

steppe eagle. Together they represent love, freedom and the aspirations of the Kazakh people. A pattern of what is described as “national ornamentation” forms a vertical stripe near the hoist.

The new coat of arms is also based around a radiant sun. It depicts traditional features of Kazakhstan.

ARMS OF KAZAKHSTAN

The center of the arms is like the upper part of a yurt, the ancient felt tent of the Kazakh nomads



The sun's rays spread out like a yurt's supporting structure

Winged and horned horses represent historical traditions and beliefs